The Noble Vidyā-Mantra Called Jāṅgulī

Āryajāṅgulīnāmavidyā · Toh 990 · Derge Kangyur
འཕགས་པ་དབྱུ་སྐེལ་ཅན་བྱེད་རིག་སྔགས།

The Noble Vidyā-Mantra Called Jāṅgulī, known in Sanskrit as Āryajāṅgulīnāmavidyā and in Tibetan as Pakpa Dukselzhejawé Rikngak, whose Tibetan title literally means "the noble incantation called Dispeller of Poison," is a short scripture centered on a protective spell against poison and venomous snakes. It opens with the Buddha dwelling at Śrāvastī in Prince Jeta's Grove, where he tells the monks of a time long ago, when he was still a bodhisattva living in a fragrant valley on the northern slope of the Snowy Mountains. There he encountered a young maiden bearing the marks of great merit, clad in antelope hide and adorned with serpents, who ate poisonous flowers. This figure is Jāṅgulī, the goddess associated with neutralizing venom, and the text conveys her vidyā-mantra as a means of protection and healing. It is Toh 990 in the Kangyur, where it belongs among the dhāraṇī and incantation texts, the class of works devoted to spells for protection and well-being.

In the language of India: ārya jaṃguli nāma bidyā. In the language of Tibet: The Noble Vidyā-Mantra Called Jāṅgulī.

Homage to all the buddhas and bodhisattvas.

Thus did I hear at one time. The Blessed One was dwelling at Śrāvastī, in the park of Anāthapiṇḍada in Prince Jeta's Grove. Then the Blessed One said to the monks: "Monks, long ago in the past, when I was a bodhisattva,

On the northern slope of the Snowy Mountains,
On a mountain filled with the fragrance of incense,
While I was dwelling in a valley of that king of mountains,
A young maiden bearing the marks of a hundred merits,
Wearing the hide of an eṇeya antelope,
With a girdle adorned with snakes,
With venomous snakes made into her head ornament,
With ear ornaments venomous to behold,
Eating poisonous flowers
And drinking the sap of the māluta creeper,
Called out to me and had me summoned:
'Child, come here and listen to me.
I have a supreme vidyā-mantra

Called Jāṅgulī, which destroys poison.
Whatever poisons there may be,
All of them will be destroyed by my name.'

tadyathā oṃ ili mitte tili mitte ili tili mitte dumbe dumbāliye dusme dusmaliye tarake takarṇe marma marmeraṇe kaśmīri kaśrīrmugte aghe aghaṇe agṇanaghaṇe ilī alīe akhā īe abyā ie śvete śata duṇḍe anurakte svāhā

Monks, this Jāṅgulī vidyā-mantra of mine is a gift entirely white. Whoever hears this vidyā-mantra even once will not be bitten by a snake for seven years. Poison will have no effect on his body. If any snake seizes him, its head will split into seven pieces, like the bud of the arjaka tree.

These secret mantra formulas should not be recited in front of a snake. If one asks why, it is because that snake would die.

tadyathā ilala cilalī cakrabakko kauḍa kauḍeḍi kuruta kuruḍati poḍāti burudā purudeti moḍeti nikuruḍe nikuruḍe nimamuruta nimamuruḍete purude phuttareha phutta phuṭṭa ṭṭaṃḍarahe nāgarāhe nagattadataṇḍarahe sarbarahe sarbatattadaraha acchi acchi buruṭata calabiṣe śīte śītā banhale mātāle hale hale hala hala halale ilale kipacale milale taṇḍi taṇḍi taṭa taṭa sphuṭa sphuṭa phaṭṭa phaṭṭa harabiśva svāhā

Monks, thus, whatever vidyā-mantras Jāṅgulī has spoken and recited to all the assemblies of bhūta spirits, all of them are just so. They are not otherwise; they are just so. They are genuine. They are true. They are unerring. They are not inverted. May this poison become harmless! Go back to the one who gave it! Go back to the one who seized! Go into fire! Go into water! Go onto the plain! Go into the snow! Go into the wall! Go into the sky! Go into the earth! May it be pacified! svāhā"

When the Blessed One had spoken thus, those monks rejoiced and praised what the Blessed One had said.

This concludes the noble vidyā-mantra called Jāṅgulī.

Translator's Notes

• The Tibetan word for the figure who appears on the mountain is gender-neutral ("youth"). She is rendered as "young maiden" for two reasons: she is the goddess Jāṅgulī, who speaks of "my name", and the Sanskrit tradition of this text calls her a maiden.

The phrase rendered "a gift entirely white" is literal and somewhat obscure. It probably means a wholly pure or beneficial gift.

The line "While I was dwelling in a valley of that king of mountains" is grammatically ambiguous in the Tibetan. It could also be read as describing where the maiden dwelt.

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.